

GLEBIONIS CORONARIA

Glebionis coronaria (formerly Chrysanthemum coronarium)

Quick Facts

Scientific Name	Glebionis coronaria (formerly Chrysanthemum coronarium)
Family	Asteraceae (Daisy family)
Common Names	Crown Daisy, Garland Chrysanthemum, Edible Chrysanthemum, Shungiku (Japanese), Tong Ho (Chinese), Chop Suey Greens, Kikuna
Native Origin	Mediterranean region — southern Europe and northern Africa; introduced and naturalized across Asia
Colors	Bright yellow, white, and bi-coloured (yellow outer ring with white inner zone). The flower heads are 3 to 6 cm in diameter with multiple ray florets surrounding a central disc.
Height	30 to 80 cm depending on soil fertility and growing conditions.
Blooming Season	February to April in plains of India. November to March at higher altitudes in northeastern states and Himalayan foothills. It is an annual that completes its full lifecycle from seed to flower within approximately 10 to 14 weeks in cool conditions.

Distribution in India

Grown as a cool-season vegetable and ornamental in northern and northeastern India, particularly in West Bengal, Assam, Sikkim, and hill states. Also found in parts of Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. More commonly seen in vegetable markets in cities with large East Asian communities. Grown in Darjeeling district for local consumption.

Description and Overview

Glebionis coronaria, widely known as Crown Daisy or Garland Chrysanthemum, is a flowering annual plant native to the Mediterranean region that has been extensively cultivated across Asia for both its culinary and ornamental value. The plant was formerly classified as Chrysanthemum coronarium and is closely related to the ornamental garden chrysanthemum. The taxonomic name Glebionis coronaria has been in use since 2002 when the genus was revised.

The plant produces bright yellow or bi-coloured daisy-like flowers on branching stems above deeply lobed, bright green aromatic foliage. The leaves are pinnately divided with irregularly toothed leaflets, giving the plant a lacy appearance. The entire aboveground plant is aromatic with a distinctive herbal fragrance.

What makes this plant unique among the flowers in this collection is its dual role: it is both an ornamental garden flower and an important leafy vegetable. In Chinese, Japanese, Korean, and Vietnamese cuisines, the young leaves and shoots are eaten as a vegetable — stir-fried, added to

soups, hotpots, and noodle dishes. The vegetable is called Shungiku in Japanese (meaning spring chrysanthemum), Tong Ho in Cantonese, and Ssukgat in Korean.

In India, the plant is primarily grown in regions with East Asian dietary influence — particularly in Darjeeling (West Bengal), Sikkim, and among the Tibetan and Nepali communities of the northeastern states. It is less well known in the southern and western states. In ornamental contexts, it is grown in winter garden beds across northern India for its cheerful yellow flowers.

Blooming Season and Conditions

February to April in plains of India. November to March at higher altitudes in northeastern states and Himalayan foothills. It is an annual that completes its full lifecycle from seed to flower within approximately 10 to 14 weeks in cool conditions.

Cultivation

Glebionis coronaria grows as a cool-season annual and does not tolerate frost or intense summer heat. Seeds are sown between September and November in plains of India, or between February and April in hill stations. Germination occurs within 7 to 10 days at 15 to 20 degrees Celsius. The plant grows rapidly in fertile, well-drained soil.

For vegetable production, harvesting begins when plants reach 15 to 20 cm in height, typically 6 to 8 weeks after sowing. Repeated cutting encourages re-growth. For ornamental use, plants are allowed to grow to full height and flower. The plant is relatively pest-resistant, though aphids may attack young growth in warm conditions.

Uses and Applications

Culinary vegetable: Young leaves and shoots are consumed across East and Southeast Asia in stir-fries, hotpots, noodle soups, and salads. The distinctive herbal aroma is appreciated in these cuisines.

Ornamental: Grown in winter and spring garden beds across temperate regions and hill stations for its bright yellow daisy flowers.

Traditional medicine: In Chinese traditional medicine, the plant is used as a cooling herb to reduce fever, calm the liver, and improve digestion.

Pollinator value: The open daisy flowers are excellent sources of nectar for bees and butterflies in early spring.

Interesting Facts

- The scientific name changed from *Chrysanthemum coronarium* to *Glebionis coronaria* in 2002 following a taxonomic revision, which is why it still appears under the old name in many older references.
- In Japan, Shungiku is an essential ingredient in the traditional winter hot pot dish Shabu-shabu and in temple cuisine (Shojin-ryori).
- The plant has been cultivated in China for over a thousand years and is mentioned in ancient Chinese agricultural texts.

- Unlike the ornamental chrysanthemum, *Glebionis coronaria* can be grown easily from seed in a kitchen garden and harvested within two months.
- The flowers are edible and are used as a garnish in Japanese bento boxes and salads.

Source: Flower AI Knowledge Base — GLEBIONIS CORONARIA entry. Scientific name: *Glebionis coronaria* (formerly *Chrysanthemum coronarium*). Family: Asteraceae (Daisy family).